THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE, RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee, NOTING the new regulation II-1/3-6 of the In ternational Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea (SOLAS), 1974, as amended (hereinaft er referred to as ■the Convention■) adopted by resolution MSC.134(76), concerning access to and with in spaces in the cargo area of oil tankers and bulk carriers, NOTING ALSO that the aforementioned regulation provides that the means of access referred to therein shall comply with the requirements of Technical provisions for means of access for inspections (hereinafter referred to as ■the Technical provisions■) to be made mandatory under the Convention; RECOGNIZING that the Technical provisions referred to above are not intended to - access for inspections (hereinafter referred to as ■the Technical provisions■) to be made mandatory under the Convention; RECOGNIZING that the Technical provisions referred to above are not intended to inhibit the development of new or novel technol ogies which provide for an improved means to carry out ship surveys and inspections, HAVING CONSIDERED, at its seventy-sixth session, the text of the proposed Technical provisions, 1. ADOPTS the Technical provisions for means of access for inspections, the text of which is set out in the Annex to the present resolution; 2. INVITES Contracting Governments to th e Convention to note that the Technical provisions will take effect on 1 January 2005 upon en try into force of the new regulation II-1/3-6 of the Convention; 3. REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit certified copies of this resolution and the text of the Technical provisions contained in th e Annex to all Contracting Governments to the Convention; 4. FURTHER REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit copies of this resolution and the Annex to all Members of the Organization, which are not Contracting Governments to the Convention; - Convention; 4. FURTHER REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit copies of this resolution and the Annex to all Members of the Organization, which are not Contracting Governments to the Convention; 5. INVITES Governments to encourage the de velopment of novel technologies aimed at facilitating the survey and inspection of ships and to keep the Organization advised of any positive results.

RESOLUTION MSC.133(76) (adopted on 12 December 2002) ADOPTION OF TECHNICAL PROVISIONS FOR MEANS OF ACCESS FOR INSPECTIONSMSC 76/23/Add.1 ANNEX 2 Page 2 I:\MSC\76\23-ADD.1.DOC ANNEX TECHNICAL PROVISIONS FOR MEANS OF ACCESS FOR INSPECTIONS Preamble It has long been recognised that the only way of ensuring that the condition of ship■sstructure is maintained to conform with the applicable requirements is for all its components to be surveyed on aregular basis throughout their operationa llife so as to ensure that they are free